- *Immutable*, because each newly created block is linked to the existing blockchain by the hash value of the current head of the blockchain, as shown in figure 1.8.

At this point, it is sufficient to know that a representative signature value of the block *n* is stored in the block *n*+1 to ensure immutability. Any inadvertent or deliberate change to a block's data at a node will change the block's hash value and render that node's chain invalid. (You'll learn more about the hash value and its computation in chapter 5.) The blocks of a blockchain are stored in the local file systems of the participant nodes, as shown in figure 1.9. The chain of blocks on each node is the distributed ledger recording Txs and related data in its blocks. Figure 1.9 depicts the fact that every node has an exact copy of the blockchain.

